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Summarize the 1906 San Francisco Earthquake. What factors shaped the current landscape?

The 1906 San Francisco earthquake, which struck on **April 18, 1906**, was one of the most devastating in U.S. history. Its estimated magnitude was **7.8**, originating along the **San Andreas Fault**, and it caused widespread destruction throughout San Francisco and surrounding areas.

Key Impacts

1. **Immediate Damage**
   - Massive ground shaking destroyed thousands of buildings.
   - Fires, sparked by broken gas lines and exacerbated by delayed firefighting efforts, destroyed much of the city—some estimates suggest up to **80% of San Francisco** was affected.
   - Thousands were left homeless, and death estimates range from **3,000 to 6,000**.
2. **Economic and Social Effects**
   - The disaster disrupted the local economy, businesses, and infrastructure.
   - Large-scale reconstruction efforts transformed the city's architecture and urban planning.
3. **Engineering and Urban Changes**
   - The earthquake highlighted the need for stricter building codes.
   - San Francisco introduced seismic safety standards and more resilient infrastructure.

Factors Shaping the Current Landscape

1. **Geological**
   - Movement along the **San Andreas Fault** permanently altered local terrain in some areas.
   - Liquefaction in parts of the city (especially reclaimed areas like the Marina District) influenced building safety and zoning.
2. **Urban Planning and Architecture**
   - Rebuilding favored modern construction techniques, wider streets, and more open spaces to reduce fire risks.
   - Landmark buildings, like the **City Hall**, were reconstructed with reinforced materials.
3. **Economic and Social Development**
   - The disaster accelerated migration, investment, and urban growth in the following decades.
   - Neighborhoods were reshaped by both the destruction and the reconstruction, influencing the city's current demographic and cultural layout.

In essence, the 1906 earthquake not only reshaped San Francisco physically but also transformed its urban planning, building practices, and social landscape—effects still visible today in its seismic-aware architecture and city layout.

If you want, I can also make a **visual map showing the before-and-after earthquake changes in San Francisco** to illustrate how the landscape shifted. Do you want me to do that?

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